

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Truck and Delivery Driver English



Vocabulary & phrasebook

Keep precise meanings and useful expressions close. Retrieve the words, then use them in a complete message.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For Truck drivers, local delivery drivers, and driver helpers.

All cases, names, quantities, schedules, and company arrangements are fictional English practice, not driving, loading, cargo-handling, legal, or safety training. Service terms and duties vary. Follow employer training and applicable requirements; refer vehicle operation, access safety, claims, fees, and regulatory decisions to responsible qualified people. Phone conversations take place while parked, never while driving.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Make vocabulary usable

Knowing a definition is a start. To use a term well, explain it in plain English, connect it to a case, and choose a natural sentence around it.

- Read five terms, cover their definitions, and recall the meanings.
- Sort a pair you might confuse and explain the difference.
- Use one term in a sentence about a fictional case.
- Ask a partner to explain the sentence without repeating the specialist word.
- Return to the same terms on another day and test recall again.

Abbreviations need context

Expand an abbreviation on first use when the listener needs it. Some abbreviations have different meanings across professions: API can refer to an application programming interface or an active pharmaceutical ingredient. The course context determines the meaning.

Definitions have limits

These are concise language-learning explanations, not complete legal, clinical, or technical specifications. Use the applicable authoritative definition for regulated or operational decisions.

Field vocabulary A-Z

access restriction

A site condition or rule limiting where or when delivery can take place.

bill of lading

A transport document identifying the shipment, parties, and goods; its legal effect depends on the shipment and applicable rules.

collection point

A designated location where an eligible recipient can collect a shipment.

collection reference

The identifier matching a pickup booking with the goods being collected.

concealed damage

Damage to contents that is not apparent from the outside at receipt.

consignee

The person or business named to receive a shipment.

curbside delivery

A delivery service with handover at the agreed curbside location, as defined by the booking.

delay notice

A message explaining that planned delivery timing has changed.

delivery attempt

A visit made to complete delivery, whether or not goods are handed over.

delivery instruction

A shipment-specific note about where or how receipt is arranged.

delivery receipt

A record acknowledging delivery and any recorded qualifications about it.

delivery window

The agreed period during which a delivery is expected or accepted.

dispatch log

The dispatch team's record of route events and messages.

estimated time of arrival

The currently expected arrival time, often shortened to ETA, rather than a guaranteed arrival.

exception note

A record of a specific irregularity noticed during delivery.

follow-up owner

The named person responsible for the next action on an unresolved delivery issue.

inside delivery

A booked service including movement to a specified interior location within stated conditions.

outstanding stop

A scheduled delivery whose outcome still needs completion or clarification.

packing list

An itemized description of the contents packed for an order.

piece count

The number of separately counted packages or handling units, with the unit stated.

proof of delivery

A record supporting a delivery event, such as named receipt or other evidence required for that service.

receiving cutoff

The latest time a site accepts a specified delivery under its booking arrangements.

recipient unavailable

A status indicating that an appropriate person could not be reached to receive a shipment.

redelivery

Another delivery visit arranged after an earlier visit did not complete delivery.

refused delivery

A delivery that the recipient explicitly declines to accept.

return authorization

Approval identifying goods accepted for return under a business's return arrangements.

return label

A label identifying the destination and reference for goods sent back.

revised appointment

A replacement delivery booking agreed after the original booking changes.

service level

The delivery features and limits included in a particular booking.

short shipment

A delivery containing fewer goods than the agreed or documented quantity.

stop sequence

The planned order of delivery locations on a route.

visible damage

Damage observable on the outside of a shipment during the check.

Expressions for this course

Complete the frames with the facts of your case. A frame helps organize meaning; it should not replace an actual explanation.

Ask which destination a note identifies

The label names ___, while the note says ___.

Which entrance receives deliveries for ___?

So ___ refers to ___, not ___.

An address can identify a building without identifying the consignee. Ask a narrow question and repeat the answer.

Word combinations in this lesson

confirm the receiving address: check the shipment's actual destination

read back the suite number: repeat it for confirmation

check the stop sequence: identify the planned next delivery

clarify the delivery window: establish the agreed arrival period

State what was actually counted

The document lists ___ cartons; we counted ___.

That confirms ___, but not ___.

Can we note the difference against ___?

A carton count and a product count answer different questions. Name the unit and evidence.

Word combinations in this lesson

reconcile the piece count: compare counted units with the document

count by carton: state cartons rather than individual products

note a shortage: record the confirmed missing quantity

match the shipment reference: ensure documents concern the same load

Separate arrival, acceptance, and update times

Our current estimated arrival is ____.

That falls ____ the receiving cutoff.

Please confirm the booking status by ____.

A later estimate does not extend a cutoff. Agree the next message time without promising delivery.

Word combinations in this lesson

revise the arrival estimate: give the latest supported timing

miss the receiving cutoff: arrive after the acceptance time

give an update by noon: promise a communication time

request a revised appointment: ask for another confirmed slot

Describe damage without diagnosing it

The visible condition is ____.

We haven't established whether ____.

The note can say ____ without implying ____.

Packaging damage, possible product damage, and responsibility are separate claims.

Word combinations in this lesson

describe the outer carton: report packaging condition

record an exception: attach a factual delivery qualification

avoid assigning blame: separate observation from cause

check the receipt wording: ensure it matches the observed issue

Offer options without inventing availability

I reached ____ at ____, but ____.

You could request ____; availability depends on ____.

Please wait for confirmation before ____.

An attempted delivery is not completed delivery. Separate confirmed options from possibilities.

Word combinations in this lesson

record the attempted delivery: state the visit and outcome

reach the named contact: try the listed recipient

arrange a redelivery: obtain another booking

confirm collection availability: verify when and where collection is possible

Decline an unbooked extra courteously

The booked service includes ___, but not ___.

I can't add ___ at this stop.

Dispatch can review ___ before you decide.

State the service boundary without judging the customer. An upgrade request is not confirmation.

Word combinations in this lesson

check the booked service level: verify what is included

identify an access restriction: explain a limiting site condition

request a service change: ask for a different delivery service

agree the handover point: confirm the permitted receipt location

Keep an extra return separate

This reference covers ___, not ___.

Does the extra carton have ___?

I'll describe it as an additional request until ___.

Wanting to return an item does not automatically match it to a collection booking.

Word combinations in this lesson

match the return reference: connect goods with their approval

distinguish refusal from absence: report why handover failed

confirm the collection quantity: agree the booked units

query an extra carton: check an unlisted package

Hand over evidence and unresolved work separately

The delivery occurred at ___; the record is ___.

The customer reported ___; we have not verified ___.

Can you take ___ and confirm ___?

A missing upload is not automatically a failed delivery. Preserve the event, record status, and next owner.

Word combinations in this lesson

reconcile the delivery status: compare records with events

name the follow-up owner: identify who takes the next action

flag a missing receipt: separate missing evidence from missing delivery

close the communication loop: obtain acknowledgment of the handoff

Model responses in context

Read the situation first. Cover the model, say your own response, and compare the two for meaning and tone.

01 | Confirming the delivery destination

Shipment 418 names Alder Books at 26 Mill Street, suite 4. The route note says rear annex. The receiver confirms that the annex belongs to suite 6; suite 4 uses the staffed front desk. Dispatch must correct the conflicting note.

Shipment 418 names suite 4, but the route note points to the rear annex. Could you confirm which entrance receives Alder Books deliveries? I need the receiving location for this shipment, not just the building address. I'll ask dispatch to correct the note once we have that distinction clear.

Try it again: Dispatch asks whether all deliveries use the front desk. Limit the correction to Alder Books.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

02 | Checking shipment counts

At Finch Office Supplies, the bill of lading lists twelve cartons. Driver and receiver count eleven. Contents have not been checked; dispatch has no location for the twelfth carton.

The bill of lading lists twelve cartons, and we have counted eleven together. That is a one-carton difference, not a confirmed count of missing individual products. Could we record the carton shortage against this shipment reference? Dispatch will investigate the remaining carton; I don't have its location or a replacement date.

Try it again: A colleague says one missing carton means twelve missing products. Ask for the packing detail.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

03 | Updating an arrival estimate

Driver is parked and calls dispatch at 10:20. Estimated arrival is 11:40; receiver's cutoff is 11:30. No later slot is confirmed. Dispatch can contact receiving and update the driver by 10:40.

I'm parked and calling about stop five. The estimated arrival is now 11:40, ten minutes after the receiver's 11:30 cutoff. A later appointment hasn't been confirmed. Please check whether receiving can offer another slot and update me by 10:40. I can't describe the original window as achievable on the current estimate.

Try it again: The receiver offers tomorrow at nine. Explain that dispatch still needs to confirm the revised plan.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

04 | Describing a delivery exception

At Grove Studio, one carton has a crushed lower corner. Contents remain unopened. Receiver wants the receipt to say 'broken equipment caused by driver.' Driver can record visible condition, not establish unseen damage or fault.

The lower corner of this carton is crushed; that is what we can both see. We haven't inspected the contents, and I can't establish when the damage occurred. Could the exception note describe the crushed corner without stating that the equipment is broken or assigning responsibility? The claim review can consider further evidence.

Try it again: The customer asks whether the note guarantees compensation. Separate a record from a claim decision.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

05 | When the recipient cannot receive

At 14:10, driver is outside Marlow Design's closed receiving office. Listed contact answers and can return at 15:00. Driver cannot commit to waiting; dispatch can review redelivery, while collection availability is unknown.

I reached your receiving office at 14:10, but no recipient was available. I understand you can return at 15:00; I can't confirm that this route can wait until then. We can ask dispatch about redelivery. Collection may be another option, but its location and availability still need confirmation before you travel.

Try it again: The customer prefers collection. Confirm the preference without inventing a collection appointment.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

06 | Explaining the booked service boundary

A household delivery is booked curbside. Customer requests upstairs placement. Driver cannot add inside service; dispatch can review an upgrade or rearrangement. No price or timing is known.

Your booking shows curbside delivery, whereas you need the cartons taken upstairs. That additional service isn't included in the booking I have, and I can't add it here. I can contact dispatch to review an inside-delivery option or rearrangement. We'll need the service details confirmed before promising a location, price, or date.

Try it again: The customer offers informal cash. Keep the request within the company's booking review without inventing a fee.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

07 | Matching a return to its collection

Return R62 lists two printer cartons. Customer presents them and a third carton of cables without a matching reference. Dispatch can query the additional carton; the original two are identifiable.

Collection R62 covers two printer cartons, and both match the booking. The cable carton has no matching reference, so I need to query it separately. Is there another return authorization for that carton? I can report the additional request, but I can't describe it as included in R62 without confirmation.

Try it again: The cables came in the same purchase. Explain why that does not prove they share the collection reference.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

08 | Closing a route with a clear handoff

Route 12 is ending. Stop 7 was received by Mei at 16:05 but its receipt has not uploaded. Stop 8 was refused because the customer reported a duplicate order. Evening dispatcher Jo will check the receipt and contact customer service about stop 8.

For route 12, stop 7 was received by Mei at 16:05, but the receipt upload is still pending. Stop 8 was refused; the customer said the order was a duplicate. Jo, please take the receipt follow-up and pass the refusal to customer service. Can you confirm those two items remain distinct in the dispatch log?

Try it again: Another screen labels both stops 'exception.' Explain the different events beneath that label.

AI extension: build and retrieve vocabulary from this case.

Use the language responsibly

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Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Heavy and Tractor-Trailer Truck Drivers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/transportation-and-material-moving/heavy-and-tractor-trailer-truck-drivers.htm>

BLS Occupational Outlook Handbook: Delivery Truck Drivers and Driver/Sales Workers

<https://www.bls.gov/ooh/transportation-and-material-moving/delivery-truck-drivers-and-driver-sales-workers.htm>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the next two prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Guided message practice gives four choices with explained feedback. Vocabulary, grammar and review prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has eight practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

The two starter prompts use B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-28. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Build vocabulary and collocations

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT | ONLINE VERSION

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

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Lesson 01: Confirming the delivery destination

Original fictional case: Shipment 418 names Alder Books at 26 Mill Street, suite 4. The route note says rear annex. The receiver confirms that the annex belongs to suite 6; suite 4 uses the staffed front desk. Dispatch must correct the conflicting note.

Language workshop: Ask which destination a note identifies

Communication goal: Resolve conflicting location details using names and reference numbers.

Language guidance: An address can identify a building without identifying the consignee. Ask a narrow question and repeat the answer.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): The label names ___, while the note says ___. / Which entrance receives deliveries for ___? / So ___ refers to ___, not ___.

Vocabulary: consignee: The person or business named to receive a shipment. / delivery window: The agreed period during which a delivery is expected or accepted. / stop sequence: The planned order of delivery locations on a route. / delivery instruction: A shipment-specific note about where or how receipt is arranged.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: Receiver: suite 4 uses the staffed front desk; the annex serves suite 6.

Guided response task: Complete a workplace dialogue by selecting one of four supplied options. Compare the feedback and say the completed exchange aloud. Do not write an open-ended message.

Optional second-round challenge: Dispatch asks whether all deliveries use the front desk. Limit the correction to Alder Books.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: Shipment 418 names suite 4, but the route note points to the rear annex. Could you confirm which entrance receives Alder Books deliveries? I need the receiving location for this shipment, not just the building address. I'll ask dispatch to correct the note once we have that distinction clear.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Retrieve occupational vocabulary

1. Select four terms from the reference. Explain each in plain English, give two natural collocations and quote or create a short workplace example. Label invented examples. Contrast each term with a plausible confusable term; acknowledge regional variation.
2. Present one role-labelled exchange with one missing word or phrase and four choices A-D. Exactly one choice must fit the stated facts and grammar. Stop and wait for my answer before revealing it.
3. Explain all four options, then invite me to read the completed exchange aloud. Offer a sentence frame for optional spoken practice, never an open-ended writing assignment.
4. Repeat for the other three terms, one question at a time. Vary the correct letter and the situation; preserve the reference facts. If a choice is ambiguous, replace the item.
5. Finish with two new four-choice collocation questions for later review, with a clearly separate answer key. Do not claim to schedule a reminder.

END PROMPT

Test recall and transfer

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END REFERENCE

TASK: Review with supported choices and speaking

1. Ask me to close my notes. Prepare six four-choice questions: two vocabulary gaps, one grammar contrast, one confirmed-versus-unknown distinction, one choice of reply, and one transfer to a clearly labelled fictional variation.
2. Show only the first question. Use a short role-labelled exchange or a concrete scenario, four plausible choices A-D, and exactly one defensible answer. Stop and wait.
3. After each answer explain all options, offer one hint for a retry if needed, and invite me to say the completed exchange aloud. Only then move on. Do not request an original written response.
4. Track whether I answered independently or with a hint, not a certified proficiency score. Do not assess pronunciation from typed text. Replace ambiguous questions and accept valid spoken alternatives.
5. Give a compact review card with three four-choice recall items and a separate answer section. Summarize two specific successes and two points to revisit. Do not claim to remember or schedule future sessions.

END PROMPT